

JAIDEEP PHATAK, PMP®

Senior Project Manager | Program & Portfolio Governance | Stakeholder Governance |

Risk Management | AI-Augmented Delivery

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Senior Project Manager with over 10 years of experience, 7 years leading cross-functional program delivery, stakeholder governance, and portfolio management across OEM and Tier-1 environments in the USA, UAE, and India, including 7+ years directing VAVE, benchmarking, and multi-program portfolios end to end in the automotive sector. Directed 80+ engineers across three continents spanning APAC, EU, and North American accounts, with direct CXO-level steering committee accountability across \$8M–\$10M+ in cumulative program budgets and 35+ programs delivered. Delivered a 40% reduction in program cycle times, and first-time-right quality improvement from ~50% to ~90% - through structured governance, risk management, and process standardisation that translate directly to complex, multi-stakeholder program environments. Combines execution-level operational depth with AI-enabled reporting, Power BI dashboards, and Lean Six Sigma discipline.

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- **Scale & Leadership: 80+ engineers directed** across the USA, UAE, and India, spanning APAC, EU, and North American OEM programs, with direct CXO steering committee reporting and cross-functional stakeholder management
- **Portfolio Governance: 35+ programs** governed across cumulative **portfolios of \$8M–\$10M+** (Trucks, SUVs, EVs, BEV), achieving 95%+ on-time delivery through stage-gate governance, risk mitigation, and RAID management
- **Delivery Transformation: 40% reduction** in programme cycle times (20–24 weeks to 12–14 weeks) and First-Time-Right quality improvement from ~50% to ~90% through SOP standardisation and process redesign
- **Resource Optimisation: Billable** utilisation improved from ~60% to ~80% through structured resource planning and utilisation-matrix tracking

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Freelance – Program & Portfolio Management, AI Enablement

Jun 2026 – Present

Pune, India

- Engaged as an AI training expert with Micro1, evaluating and refining English-language model responses for clarity, accuracy, and natural communication
- Concurrently building an executive portfolio of AI-enabled Program & Portfolio Command Centers, governance dashboards, and stage-gate control systems, alongside targeted coursework in AI-augmented programme management

Project Manager

Oct 2025 – May 2026

Caresoft Technologies LLC OPC | Ras Al Khaimah, UAE

- **OEM Technical Program Lead:** Led delivery for 3 global OEM accounts, managing a 30-member cross-functional team across UAE and India and resolving escalations through structured governance, resulting in on-time delivery and improved customer satisfaction
- **Training & Enablement:** Delivered 60–70 enablement sessions for 10 OEM clients and 25+ suppliers, creating role-based training that reduced recurring escalations and improved first-time issue resolution
- **Idea Governance & Compliance:** Owned lifecycle tracking for ~200 tool ideas across engineering and product teams, achieving ~50% approval rates and zero unresolved escalations across ~32 compliance audits in UAE facilities

Project Manager

Apr 2024 – Sep 2025

Caresoft Global Technologies | Livonia, Michigan, USA

- Owned day-to-day operations for the US delivery facility, coordinating 80+ engineers across the USA and India while maintaining OEM delivery commitments and escalation control
- **Portfolio Governance:** Managed 15 benchmarking programs across a \$3M+ budget, supporting 2–3 new OEM engagements and 2–3 renewals through reliable delivery and stakeholder management
- **Team Performance:** Improved billable utilisation from ~60% to ~80% and first-time-right delivery from ~50% to ~90% by standardising QA/QC and resource planning

- **AI-Driven Efficiency:** Introduced AI-enabled automated status reporting and utilisation dashboards, reducing manual reporting effort and improving stakeholder visibility across 9 concurrent programs

Senior VAVE Engineer

Jul 2023 – Apr 2024

Caresoft Global Technologies | Livonia, Michigan, USA

- Directed a 15–20 member VA/VE team on-site, secured OEM sign-off on cost and mass-reduction programs for 3 global OEMs, and delivered \$200/vehicle in savings plus ~20kg/vehicle mass reduction
- **Technical Leadership:** Established portfolio delivery for 5 benchmarking programs, coordinating a 60-member cross-functional team across the USA and India and managing up to 3 concurrent workstreams
- **VAVE Delivery:** Identified, validated, and secured OEM sign-off on VAVE cost/mass-reduction opportunities, delivering \$200/vehicle in savings and ~20kg/vehicle mass reduction

Project Manager

Feb 2023 – Jun 2023

Caresoft Global Technologies | Livonia, Michigan, USA

- Established structured portfolio delivery for 5 automotive benchmarking programmes (up to 3 concurrent), coordinating a 60-member cross-functional team (40 onsite USA, 20 India) across SUVs on EV, ICE, and Hybrid platforms
- **Budget & Process Governance:** Owned budgets of \$1M–\$1.5M per customer program and \$800K–\$1M for internal programs, delivering 4 of 5 on time and within budget while using RAID reviews to improve subsequent cycles

Automotive Benchmarking Analyst

Sep 2019 – Feb 2023

Caresoft Global Technologies | Livonia, Michigan, USA

- Progressed from individual contributor to Team Lead and Project Lead, managing 18 benchmarking programs and coordinating a 40-member on-site team across multiple vehicle platforms
- **Global Standardisation:** Supported expansion from 2 to 6 global facilities and standardized 20 SOPs plus 35 process checklists across functions
- **Cycle Time & Team Development:** Reduced full-vehicle program cycle times from 20–24 weeks to 12–14 weeks (~40%) while onboarding and training 15–20 associates to build a self-sufficient team

SKILLS

PROGRAM & PORTFOLIO MANAGEMENT: Program Governance | Portfolio Management | Stakeholder Management | Change Management | Risk Identification & Mitigation | Program Stage-Gate & Gate Reviews | VAVE & Cost Engineering | APQP / PPAP | DFMEA | Agile / Waterfall / Hybrid Delivery | Budget & Cost Control | Process Standardisation

STAKEHOLDER & CUSTOMER MANAGEMENT: OEM / Customer Management | Cross-Functional Team Leadership | Executive & CXO Reporting | Escalation Management | Training & Enablement | Customer Experience

ANALYTICS & REPORTING: Power BI & KPI Dashboards | AI-Augmented Reporting | Lean Six Sigma (DMAIC) | Product Lifecycle Management (PLM)

TOOLS & PLATFORMS: MS Project | Jira | Confluence | Power BI | Excel (Advanced) | SAP (exposure) | SharePoint | Monday.com | Asana | Google Workspace | GenAI (Claude, Copilot, ChatGPT, Gemini)

EDUCATION

Master of Science, Mechanical Engineering

2017 – 2018

Lamar University, Beaumont, Texas, USA | GPA: 3.54 / 4.0

Bachelor of Engineering, Mechanical Engineering

Savitribai Phule Pune University, Pune, India

CERTIFICATIONS

- PMP® – Project Management Professional (Project Management Institute)
- AI for Project Management (LinkedIn Learning)
- Lean Six Sigma Green Belt (LSSGB) – Udemy